



PILLAR 1

BUILD RAPPORT

“He cares about me.
He understands me.
He feels my pain.”

— JORDAN BELFORT

Without rapport, there is a 0% chance you get the sale.



BUILD RAPPORT

Pillar 1 of 12 • Presentation

THE GOAL

Get them to actually like you. Get them thinking you're a genuine human, not just a salesperson running a script. By the end of this pillar, they should feel like:

"This person's pretty chill. Happy to have a conversation with them. They're just another human I'm talking to."

WHY IT MATTERS

WITHOUT RAPPORT, THERE IS A 0% CHANCE YOU GET THE SALE.

Being in rapport is the single most important thing in this presentation. Everything else rests on it.

Deep rapport = compounding leverage

When you're genuinely in rapport, the effect compounds across the entire sales cycle — not just the call. You can't understate this:

- They feel bad picking another company over you.
- They feel bad cancelling after they've said yes.
- They respond to your texts and calls ongoingly.
- They tell you the truth and are honest with you in conversation.
- They genuinely think you're a nice person and root for you.

Rapport = flexibility

- **In rapport:** you can push back, challenge, hold frame, redirect. They want to hear you out.
- **Out of rapport:** every objection is a wall. They want you gone. They're internally rushing you to the end of the call.

Rapport is ongoing

The 2–5 minutes upfront is just the foundation. You're maintaining rapport across all 12 pillars. Every pillar after this, you're still building it — quick-thinking, reading the room, dropping in moments of connection throughout.

CORE PRINCIPLES

Childlike curiosity

This is the governing tone of the whole pillar. You're not asking questions to tick a box — you're genuinely curious about the human in front of you. No bullshit, no sales energy, no agenda. The customer can smell the difference instantly.

- **Don't jump in.** Spend genuine time here. 2–5 minutes is the target — read the room.
- **Be human.** Genuine care, genuine curiosity. The presentation can wait — connection can't be faked later.
- **Manufacture familiarity.** People love people who are similar to them. Find it and lean in. Example: if they're a parent, bring up you've got kids and have a genuine conversation about kids — parent to parent. They'll connect with that and think 'this guy's a genuine individual.'
- **Use setter notes if available.** If the D2D rep or cold caller flagged a dog, kids, renos, a footy team, a job — bring it up naturally. Pre-call review of setter notes is non-negotiable when they exist.
- **Dual-purpose questions.** Best rapport questions also feed you intel you'll use later in the presentation (power usage, future bills, family size). Connection + ammo at the same time.
- **They talk, you listen.** People love talking about themselves. Bring up personal stuff to open the door — but don't ramble about yourself. Keep them as the subject.
- **Make them laugh if you can.** Make jokes, keep the conversation light-hearted with humour — very beneficial when it lands. Never force it — people are turned off if you're trying too hard.
- **Light self-deprecation lands well.** Quick self-roasts lower your status and their guard. Examples: "I'm lazy, I work from home," "good my ugly mug's not blocking the screen." Use sparingly — overdo it and it gets weird.
- **Humans mirror humans.** The reason you open with a smile, hands up, easy energy — humans model and mirror each other. They'll be friendly back. It's very hard to be angry at someone who's being genuinely nice to you.
- **Read the room on time.** If they're short or angry: "Yeah no stress, mate" → move into the presentation and build rapport across the pillars as you go.

BODY LANGUAGE & DELIVERY

In-home

- Open body — no crossed arms, square to them.
- Genuine smile.
- Hands up and open — psychologically this signals no threat, no pressure. Massive at the start.
- Slow pace of speech. Not rushed.
- Easy energy. No stress, not salesy, genuine.

Zoom

Same principles, applied through the camera:

- Hands up and open — visible in frame when you gesture.
- Slow pace, smiling, open energy.
- Camera at eye level, well-lit, clean background.



- Energy slightly higher than in-home — Zoom flattens energy, compensate for it.

SAMPLE RAPPORT ANGLES (DUAL-PURPOSE)

Every question below builds rapport **and** feeds you intel for later pillars. Don't ask all of them — pick what flows naturally based on the conversation and setter notes.

What got them interested (key question)

Ask with absolute, genuine curiosity. This question only works if you actually mean it. Match "on the door" or "on the phone" to how the lead was set.

- "By the way — what was it specifically that [I/the setter] mentioned to you on the door / on the phone that got you thinking, 'you know, probably not the worst idea to have a chat with us'? Just so I know what piqued your interest, so we can have the most productive convo for you guys."

Industry awareness (key question)

Strategic question — pre-seeds Pillar 3 (Solar Industry Issues). Gets them acknowledging the industry has issues, positions you as the honest one before you've even said anything about it. Ask casually, almost like a side note.

- "Are you aware that the industry is a bit dodgy?"

Area / lifestyle

Builds connection. Tells you how settled they are, lifestyle context.

- "How's the weather over your way? I reckon it's better here in [your city]."
- "I noticed you're in [area] — how is the area honestly? You guys just move in?"
- "How long have you been in the area for?"
- "Do you like it around here?"

Work / power usage

Connection + critical intel for Pillar 8 (Power Bill Pain) and Pillar 9 (Solar Savings Breakdown).

- "What do you do for work?" — builds connection, gives you intel on schedule and household income context.
- "Do you work from home?" — tells you daytime usage, directly impacts solar economics.

Relationship

Warm rapport zone. Couples often appreciate genuine interest in their relationship. Don't push if they're not in the mood.

- "How long you guys been married — what's the secret?"

Family / future usage

Connection + intel on future bill projection (kids = more usage = bigger system frame).

- "Got kids?"
- "How old are the kids?"



- “You guys planning any more?” — only if it lands naturally.

Familiarity hooks

Use setter notes here. Lean into anything you genuinely have in common.

- Same dog breed → talk about your dog.
- Same town / school / footy team → drop it in.
- They’ve got kids → talk about your kids.

FAILURE MODES (DO NOT DO)

- **Going through the motions with no tonality.** Asking rapport questions like a checklist is worse than skipping rapport entirely. They feel it instantly.
- **Rambling about yourself.** Open the door, then let them walk through it.
- **Jumping to business too fast.** Kills the chance of building real connection.
- **Forcing humour** when it isn’t landing.
- **Forcing rapport** when they’re clearly not in the mood — read the room.
- **Asking questions you don’t actually care about the answer to.** Childlike curiosity is the test — if you’re not curious, don’t ask.

TRANSITION INTO PRESENTATION

When rapport is built, flow naturally into opening the deck. No hard verbal switch — just transition into walking them through the table of contents / general overview of what you’ll cover.

Walk through the overview casually — don’t drone through every pillar. Quick high-level pass.

Once you’ve walked the overview, you deliver **The Pre-Frame** (next section). The pre-frame is the bridge into Pillar 2: Solar Explanation.



PRE-FRAME • SCRIPTED

THE PRE-FRAME

Delivered immediately after walking the table of contents. Bridges into Pillar 2: Solar Explanation.

Deliver immediately after walking through the table of contents.

“But yeah, more or less guys, what we’ll chat about:
We’ll go through some formalities, initial info, a bit about the incentives.
Most importantly, we’ll have a look at your current situation with the power companies, what that’s actually looking like now and what it’s going to look like over the next five, ten, fifteen years or so.
And we’ll take a look at maybe where you’d prefer to be instead.
And if you feel like what we chat about makes sense for your family long-term — like, for example, if you’re saving an extra hundred bucks a month or something crazy [chuckle] — we’re happy to show you the potential next steps.
But honestly guys, that’s pretty much it. I’m chill, so don’t worry if you have any questions or anything — feel free to shoot and I’ll answer as best as I can. But yeah that’s it, we’ll jump into it now. That all sounds helpful?”

TONALITY (CRITICAL)

Absolute casual energy. So chill, so low pressure. The whole vibe is “if we can help, we’ll help.” It should feel like you’re thinking out loud, not reciting a script.

The chuckle on “**or something crazy**” is the most important tonality beat in the pre-frame. Without it, the \$100 number feels like a sales pitch. With it, it feels like a casual aside.

WHAT EACH LINE IS DOING

- “**More or less guys, what we’ll chat about**” — opens low-pressure, casual, framed as a chat not a pitch.
- “**Some formalities, initial info, a bit about the incentives**” — downplays structure of the call. Plants incentives early to pre-seed company credibility and finance pillars.
- “**Current situation... now and over the next 5, 10, 15 years**” — past/present/future framing. Plants the seed that doing nothing has a cost. Pre-seeds Pillar 8 (Power Bill Pain).
- “**Where you’d prefer to be instead**” — open, curious, lets them fill in the blank with their own future. Don’t answer it for them.
- “**Makes sense for your family long-term**” — family framing, not them-framing. Lowers pressure. They decide if it makes sense.



- **“Saving an extra hundred bucks a month or something crazy”** — concrete number, casual delivery. Pre-seeds Pillar 9 without over-promising. Under-promise here, over-deliver in Pillar 9.
- **“We’re happy to show you the potential next steps”** — soft language. Not “we’ll sign you up.” Just “potential next steps.”
- **“Honestly guys, that’s pretty much it. I’m chill, so don’t worry”** — relieves all pressure. Frames you as easy-going. Implies the whole thing is simple, no hard sell coming.
- **“Feel free to shoot and I’ll answer as best as I can”** — actively invites questions. Makes them feel comfortable interrupting instead of bottling up objections.
- **“But yeah that’s it, we’ll jump into it now”** — momentum line. Signals rapport phase is ending and substance is starting, without being abrupt.
- **“That all sounds helpful?”** — soft trial close on the format itself. Now they’ve agreed to the structure of the call before any selling has happened.

AFTER THE PRE-FRAME

Wait for the soft yes (“yeah,” “yep,” “sounds good”). Then transition directly into **Pillar 2: Solar Explanation**.

If they ask any clarifying questions here — answer briefly, then continue. Don’t get pulled into selling early.

Remember: no objections at the close = good presentation. If they object later, audit which pillar you rushed or skipped. Pillar 1 is usually the one most reps under-invest in.